



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Candeo Schools
School Website: <https://candeoschools.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (<https://austinclassical.org/>) exhibits a strong classical, Christian identity across mission, aims, curriculum, and much of its pedagogy, with clear commitments to the Trivium, the Great Books/Great Conversation, Scripture, virtue formation, and robust parent partnership in a collaborative model. Evidence is abundant for: - Religious and metaphysical foundations grounded in Christ and the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty). - Purpose and goals focused on wisdom and virtue, formation of the whole person, and contemplation of truth, goodness, and beauty. - Curriculum explicitly structured by the Trivium, engaging the Bible and great works of the Western tradition, plus Latin and history.

Pedagogy shows strong Lower School memory work (songs, recitation) and Upper School discussion/debate; however, explicit mention of "scholé/restful learning" and formal rhetoric deliverables (e.g., capstone orations) is not prominent in the sample crawl. Faculty pages give limited explicit statements about "teachers as mentors/living curriculum," and while parent partnership is emphatic, parent formation opportunities are less explicit in the crawl sample.

Aggregate result: CLASSICAL, with "Somewhat Classical" marks in Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community due to partial coverage. Keyword analysis was performed using the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" lexicon and cues, applying positive/negative indicators in each category to justify ratings.

Key site sources used: - Mission/purpose and basics: "About Us" and "Classical Education Basics" pages. - Educational approach (Trivium, Bible, great works, Latin, history, music): "Our Educational Approach/The Trivium" page. - Collaborative model and parent co-teaching: "Collaborative Schedule" page. - House system evidence: "Our First Annual Spirit Week ... House of Hildegard" post.

Detailed Classicality Audit

Method: For each category, I listed keywords/phrases found on the school site, mapped them to the positive/negative indicators in the Six Elements lexicon (and associated cues), counted positive vs negative "hits," estimated coverage of the sub-elements, and assigned a rating. Keyword lists and scoring framework are from Six Essential Elements and the classicality lexicon.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- "Glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"; "wise, virtuous, and humble students"

- “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “great books ... great conversation” (aim and method)
- “Scripture teaches ... made in the image of God ... see God’s goodness, truth, and beauty” (Biblical and theological grounding, imago Dei)
- Positive matches vs Six Elements lexicon: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, Christian/Christ, Bible/Scripture, image of God (imago Dei), formation of the soul (whole-person language).
- Negative matches: none observed (e.g., values-neutral, secular humanism absent).
- Sub-element coverage:
- Transcendental moral realism (yes).
- Grounded in theology (yes).
- Liturgical/communal worship practices (not explicitly referenced in crawl sample).
- Counts and score:
- Positive hits: 12 | Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 2/3 ≈ 0.67
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- Aim: cultivate wisdom and virtue; method: contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful; tools: Trivium, great books; “education is the cultivation of wisdom and virtue”.
- Whole-person formation: “educate the whole person ... mind, body, and soul”.
- Positive matches vs Six Elements lexicon: wisdom, virtue, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, great conversation/great books, contemplation.
- Negative matches: none (e.g., college-and-career-ready/21st-century-skills emphasis absent).
- Sub-element coverage:
- Cultivation of wisdom and virtue (yes).
- Pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty (yes).
- Formation, not mere information (yes).
- Counts and score:
- Positive hits: 10 | Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage estimate: 3/3 = 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- Trivium explicitly: grammar, logic, rhetoric; page-long exposition of memory (grammar stage), reason (logic stage), and rhetorical development; structured “loosely along those lines”.
- Content: Bible, great works of the Western tradition, history, Latin, English composition, art, music, math, science; “great books” and “great conversation”.
- “History” (not “social studies”) is used throughout the site.
- Positive matches vs Six Elements lexicon: Trivium, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, history, music; integrated/interconnected knowledge (stated as “show the interconnectedness of all knowledge”).
- Negative matches: none (e.g., “social studies” preference, progressive framing absent).
- Sub-element coverage:
- Seven Liberal Arts: strong Trivium; Quadrivium terms not explicit though math/music present (partial).
- Great Books and primary sources (yes).
- Integrated/harmonious approach (explicitly emphasized).
- Integration and wonder: contemplation/beauty/imaginings emphasized (proximal to wonder).
- Counts and score:
- Positive hits: 11 | Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage estimate: ≈ 0.88 (Trivium full; Quadrivium partial; other two sub-elements present)

- Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- Lower school: “memorization, recitation, and songs”; memory work is emphasized.
- Middle/Upper: “debate and discussion” in logic-stage years; rhetorical development implied via Trivium stage language ; reasoning training and repeated practice to construct arguments.
- Positive matches vs Six Elements lexicon: memorization, recitation, singing/chanting (Lower School); discussion/debate/dialectic (Logic).
- Negative matches (present on site): repeated references to “efficient/efficiency” in the collaborative schedule page — language that, in the lexicon, can correlate with “lack of restful learning (scholé)” when it dominates the pedagogical framing.
- Sub-element coverage:
- Restful learning/scholé (not explicitly).
- Lower school songs/chant/memory (explicit).
- Lower school wonder (not explicit).
- Upper school Socratic/seminar/debate (discussion/debate present).
- Upper school rhetoric/speeches (implied by Trivium; not explicit in sample).
- Counts and score:
- Positive hits: 6 | Negative hits: 2 → percent_positive ≈ 0.75
- Coverage estimate: 3/5 = 0.60
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- “Qualified, Christian educators” and stewardship language; Employment page exists (qualifications listed) but minimal detail on “teacher as mentor/living curriculum” in sample crawl.
- Positive matches vs lexicon: Christian educators; stewardship (virtue-resonant leadership language).
- Negative matches: none (e.g., “facilitator/guide-on-the-side” framings absent).
- Sub-element coverage:
- Teachers as models of virtue (implied by Christian identity; not explicit).
- Mentorship/collegiality (not explicit in crawl sample).
- Portrait of a teacher/student (not found in sample).
- Counts and score:
- Positive hits: 2 | Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage estimate: ≈ 0.25 (few sub-elements explicitly attested)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community

- Evidence (keywords from the school):
- “Co-laboring with families” in mission; collaborative schedule with “co-teacher parents,” weekly lesson plans, and teacher office hours on home days (strong parent partnership).
- “Christ-infused education ... with the support of qualified, Christian educators” (reinforces home-school synergy).
- House system/community life evidence (“House of Hildegard”) suggests student-life traditions that support community identity.
- Positive matches vs lexicon: parent partnership, co-educators, home-centered learning days, community support.
- Negative matches: none (e.g., “parents as customers only,” limited parent involvement absent).
- Sub-element coverage:
- Partnership with families (yes—robust).

- Parent formation (book studies/workshops not observed in sample).
 - Open/hospitable campus/parent access (not observed in sample).
 - Counts and score:
 - Positive hits: 5 | Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
 - Coverage estimate: $1.5/3 \approx 0.50$ (strong on partnership; limited evidence on other two)
 - Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
-

Overall Assessment

- Category ratings:
- Religious/Metaphysical: CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The mission/aims and curriculum are unequivocally classical and Christian, with rich alignment to transcendentals, virtue formation, Trivium, Great Books, Scripture, Latin, and history as history. Pedagogical, faculty-profile, and parent/community formation signals are present but somewhat less explicit or comprehensive in the crawl sample; nevertheless, the core identity meets classical criteria overall.

What would move the needle (targeted improvements)

Note: Overall classification is CLASSICAL; these are optional refinements to strengthen weaker categories.

- Pedagogy: Publish explicit references to “Socratic seminar,” “scholé/restful learning,” and formal Upper School rhetoric deliverables (e.g., defenses, theses, capstone orations) with examples, to remove ambiguity and dampen the “efficiency” signal in pedagogy framing.
- Faculty: Add a public “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate,” highlight teacher mentorship/collegiality and classical faculty formation (e.g., Great Books seminars for faculty) to signal “living curriculum” and virtue modeling.
- Parents & Community: Surface parent-formation offerings (book clubs, classical education workshops) and explicit hospitality/access practices to bolster coverage across all community sub-elements.

Evidence Appendix (selected excerpts with citations)

- Mission: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students ... classical, Christian education.”
 - Aim/Method/Tools: “cultivate wisdom and virtue ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful ... Trivium, classical books ... integrated curriculum.”
 - Trivium, curriculum: “We believe in the approach of the trivium—grammar, logic, and rhetoric ... study the Bible, the great works of the Western tradition ... history ... Latin ... art, music, math, and science.”
 - Lower School pedagogy: “Teachers employ ... memorization, recitation, and songs with grammar students.”
 - Logic-stage pedagogy: “debate and discussion” as chief methods.
 - Parent partnership: “co-teacher parents,” weekly lesson plans from teachers, teacher office hours on homeschool days.
 - House system/community: “House of Hildegard ... Spirit Week.”
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.